

Enter Statements in Command Window

As you work in MATLAB®, you can enter individual statements in the Command Window. For example, create a variable named `a` by typing this statement at the command line:

```
a = 1
```

MATLAB immediately adds variable `a` to the workspace and displays the result in the Command Window.

```
a =
```

```
1
```

When you do not specify an output variable, MATLAB uses the variable `ans`, short for *answer*, to store the results of your calculation.

```
sin(a)
```

```
ans =
```

```
0.8415
```

The value of `ans` changes with every command that returns an output value that is not assigned to a variable.

If you end a statement with a semicolon, MATLAB performs the computation, but suppresses the display of output in the Command Window.

```
b = 2;
```

To enter multiple statements on multiple lines before running any of the statements, use **Shift+Enter** between statements. This action is unnecessary when you enter a paired keyword statement on multiple lines, such as `for` and `end`.

You also can enter more than one statement on the same line by separating statements. To distinguish between commands, end each one with a comma or semicolon. Commands that end with a comma display their results, while commands that end with a semicolon do not. For example, enter the following three statements at the command line:

```
A = magic(5), B = ones(5) * 4.7; C = A./B
```

```
A =
```

```
17    24     1     8    15
23     5     7    14    16
 4     6    13    20    22
10    12    19    21     3
11    18    25     2     9
```

```
C =
```

```
3.6170    5.1064    0.2128    1.7021    3.1915
4.8936    1.0638    1.4894    2.9787    3.4043
0.8511    1.2766    2.7660    4.2553    4.6809
2.1277    2.5532    4.0426    4.4681    0.6383
2.3404    3.8298    5.3191    0.4255    1.9149
```

MATLAB displays only the values of `A` and `C` in the Command Window.

To recall previous lines in the Command Window, press the up- and down-arrow keys, ↑ and ↓. Press the arrow keys either at an empty command line or after you type the first few characters of a command. For example, to recall the command `b = 2`, type `b`, and then press the up-arrow key.

To clear a command from the Command Window without executing it, press the Escape (**Esc**) key.

You can evaluate any statement already in the Command Window. Select the statement, right-click, and then select **Evaluate Selection**.

In the Command Window, you also can run only a portion of the code currently at the command prompt. To evaluate a portion of the entered code, select the code, and then press **Enter**.

For example, select a portion of the following code:

```
>> disp("hello"), disp("world")
```

hello

See Also

[Command Window](#)

Topics

[Check Syntax as You Type](#)

[Modify Command Window Settings](#)

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